



Step-by-Step: Import data from spreadsheets and databases

This reading outlines the steps the instructor performs in the following video, [Importing data from spreadsheets and databases](#). The video teaches you how to import a .csv file into a Google Sheet so you can analyze the data.

Keep this guide open as you watch the video. It can serve as a reference if you need additional context or clarification while following the video steps. This is not a graded activity, but you can complete these steps to practice the skills demonstrated in the video.

What you'll need

To follow along with the examples in this video, open a blank spreadsheet. Additionally, download the following .csv file:

[Example Spreadsheet - Entertainment Expenses - Sheet1](#)

[CSV File](#)

Example 1: Use the menu to import a .csv file

Sometimes, you'll need to import the data from a .csv file into a Google Sheet. A .csv file saves data in a table format. Follow the steps below to bring the data from a .csv file into a new spreadsheet.

Note: The .csv file you import will differ from the .csv file the instructor imports in the video.

1. In the menu, select File then Import. The Import file window will pop up.
2. Select Upload then Browse to select the .csv file to import. For this example, select the .csv file you downloaded in the previous section
3. Next select the Import location. You can:
 - a. Create a new spreadsheet
 - b. Insert the .csv data as a new sheet
 - c. Replace spreadsheet
 - d. Replace current sheet
 - e. Append (add) the data to the current spreadsheet
 - f. Replace the data starting with a specific cell.
4. Next, select the Separator type. Google Sheets defaults to automatically detecting separator, or delimiter, type. To manually set the delimiter type, select the dropdown menu under Separator type and choose the separator.
5. Next, determine if you would like the text to be imported with or without formatting. In the box next to Convert text to numbers, dates, and formulas, keep the checkmark if you want text data to be formatted.
6. Select Import data. The data in the .csv file will be loaded into your sheet, and you can begin using it.

Example 2: Download data from the Global Health Observatory

You can download public data from the internet, such as data from the World Health Organization and the Global Health Observatory.

Note: The Global Health Observatory's website has been updated since this video was filmed. Follow these instructions to download the .csv file the instructor uses.

1. Navigate to the [Global Health Observatory workforce statistics database](#).
2. Scroll to navigate to the Medical doctors table.

3. Then, scroll over EXPORT DATA in .csv format in the table. Right-click, then select Save link as...
4. The .csv file will download to your computer as data.csv.

Note: If you already have a .csv file named data.csv, your computer will add a number to the file name.

Medical doctors





Medical doctors (per 10,000)					
EXPORT DATA in CSV format: Right-click here & Save link ⓘ					
Location	Medical doctors (per 10,000)	Medical doctors (number)	Generalist medical practitioners (number)	Specialist medical practitioners (number)	Medical doctors (number)
Afghanistan					
2020	2.54	9880			9880
2019	2.14	8082			8082

Medical doctors (number), General medical practitioners (number), and Specialist medical practitioners (number). The EXPORT DATA in CSV format is also in the screenshot

Example 3: Use the menu to import a .csv file

Follow the steps below to bring the .csv file you downloaded, data.csv, into a new spreadsheet.

1. Open a blank spreadsheet.
2. In the menu, select File, then Import. The Import file window will pop up.
3. Select Upload then Browse to select the .csv file to import.
4. Next, select the Import location. You can:
 - a. Create a new spreadsheet
 - b. Insert the .csv data as a new sheet

- c. Replace spreadsheet
 - d. Replace current sheet
 - e. Append (add) the data to the current spreadsheet
 - f. Replace the data starting with a specific cell.
5. Next, select the Separator type.
 6. Next, determine if you would like the text to be imported with or without formatting. In the box next to Convert text to numbers, dates, and formulas, keep the checkmark if you want text data to be formatted.
 7. Select Import data.
 8. The data in the .csv file will be loaded into your sheet, and you can review and title it.